

A Short History of Git & GitHub + Important Facts

Git was created in 2005 by Linus Torvalds to manage the development of the Linux kernel. It was designed to be fast, reliable, and able to handle large projects with many contributors. Git allows developers to track changes, create branches, and merge code safely without losing work.

GitHub was launched in 2008 by Tom Preston-Werner, Chris Wanstrath, and PJ Hyett. It built on top of Git by providing a cloud-based platform where developers can host repositories, collaborate, and contribute to open-source projects easily.

Important Git & GitHub concepts:

- Repository (repo): A project folder that tracks code history
- Commit: A saved change in your project
- Branch: A separate version of your code for experimenting
- Merge: Combining changes from different branches
- Pull Request (PR): A request to merge code into a main project
- Clone: Copying a repository to your local machine
- Fork: Creating your own copy of someone else's project on GitHub

Why GitHub is important:

- Enables global collaboration between developers
- Powers open-source software development
- Helps track and manage code versions safely
- Used by companies for professional software development workflows

Today, GitHub is one of the largest developer platforms in the world, hosting millions of projects and communities.

I am the author of this story